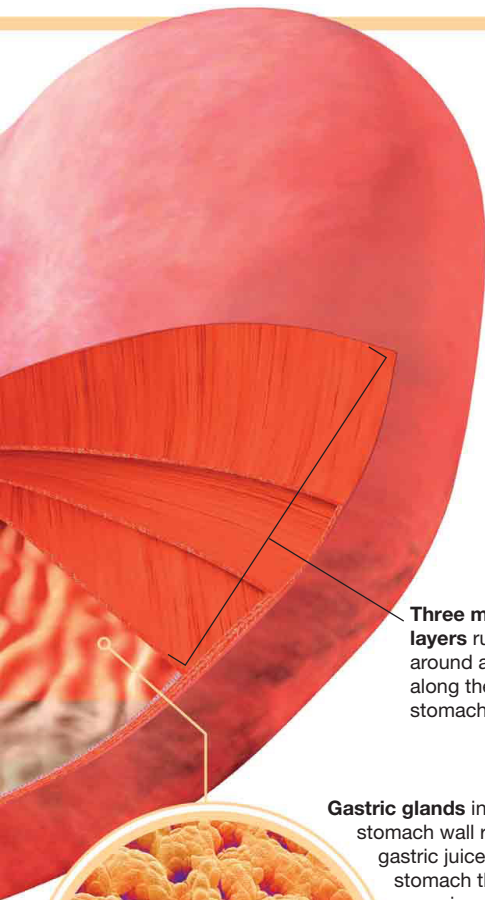




Three muscle layers run around and along the stomach

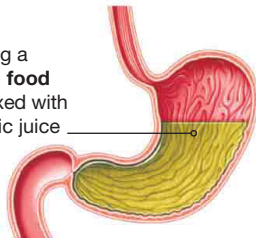
Gastric glands in the stomach wall release gastric juice into the stomach through openings called gastric pits.



Filling and emptying

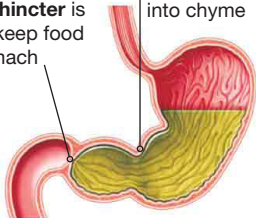
The process of filling and emptying the stomach takes at least three hours. During this time, the food is partially digested and churned into a creamy liquid called chyme. The semidigested, liquid food is then released into the duodenum through the open pyloric sphincter.

During a meal, **food** is mixed with gastric juice



About 1–2 hours after eating, the **pyloric sphincter** is closed to keep food in the stomach

Stomach wall contracts to churn food into chyme



Around 3–4 hours after eating, **chyme** is pushed through the open pyloric sphincter

